THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

PARIS BRANCH

NEWSLETTER OCTOBER 2015

Chairman's Report

I bring you good news concerning the Comradeship Services Project which has caused much ink to flow since its launch at the tail-end of 2014. After the lobbying efforts by Paris Branch, and doubtless other overseas branches of the RBL, we have now heard that all Overseas Branches are to be exempt from the scope of the Project. The immediate result is that we shall be allowed to continue the practice, with only minor technical modifications, of having members pay their annual subscriptions and any donations, direct to their local Branch, and not to London as the Comradeship Services Project had required.
This is precisely what Paris Branch had advocated back in February 2015 when I was mandated by your Committee to write to the RBL National President and National Chairman.

This is indeed good news, not least because members resident in France will continue to benefit from a reduction on their income taxes paid in France in respect of subscriptions and donations to an association "d'interet publique".

This result was achieved at a high price in terms of the extra work and stress of keeping the lobbying campaign going during the holiday months of July and August. Your officers were under great stress in that period, and some family holidays doubtless suffered, including my own. So I take this opportunity to thank on your behalf Janet Warby, David Bean and Ian McDonald for all the effort they put into making our lobbying campaign function smoothly. I was aware of a very high quality of teamwork by your officers. They have served members interests well. Our warm thanks to them and their families.

At the same time I should like to thank here Branch member Robin Baker, who carried out for us very valuable research during our lobbying on both the obligations of, and the protection provided by, the French

Loi 1901 as applied to our Branch operating as a French association within an international Federation like the RBL. He was aided in this research by BCC Chairman Christopher Chantrey. We also wish to thank Christopher Crosthwaite for the very practical help also given to us in our 1901 Association context.

In this Newsletter you will find instructions from Membership Secretary Mark Yates on the payment of your subscription and donations for 2015-16.

Since our last Newsletter we have welcomed our new President d'honneur, Colonel Geoff Wright, the current British Military Attache. We should like to thank him for his whole-hearted support of our endeavours and our activities, and this has been much appreciated by your officers.

Business as usual from now on we hope, and already we are planning for our Commonweaith Service of Remembrance in Notre Dame de Paris on 11th November. Our pipers, Paris Branch member , Murdoch MacCleod, with his son Hector, will play for us again, as will trumpeter Tim Rarick who played for us last year with such panache. Rev Jim Cowie, our Chaplain, will read the Intercessions, and Rev Canon Alyson Lamb, Chaplain of St Michael's, will give the sermon.

Our AGM will now take place on Monday 30th November in the Clubhouse at the traditional time of 18.30. Please put that in your diaries and give us your moral support by attending.

"We will remember them"
